

ZAY-MARIE PRESS

DIGITAL STUDIES MASTER STANDARD

Version 1.19 — Approved and Locked

Controlling content, design, production, approval, and publication standard for the
Zay-Marie Press Digital Studies series

Revision note (v1.19): Section 2 (Forward Cover System) is amended to add a Cover Art Brief step. Before the illustrator produces artwork, a detailed written cover art brief — image concept, composition, palette, and symbolic content — is prepared and given to the publisher to provide to the illustrator; the publisher then returns the finished artwork for typography assembly and approval. Stage 5 of Section 14 is updated to match. All other sections carry forward unchanged from v1.18.

1. Governing Principle

This document establishes the controlling content, doctrinal, structural, visual, production, approval, website, and publication standard for all Zay-Marie Press Digital Studies. Future studies are to be developed and audited against these written requirements rather than by inference from an earlier individual study.

2. Forward Cover System

The full-bleed cover architecture approved with Study 34 — Filled Again and the final-file assembly confirmed with Study 35 — Who Is the Israel of God? govern all new Digital Studies beginning with Study 34. Studies 1–33 retain their approved covers and are not to be redesigned merely to create visual uniformity. A legacy cover may be reopened only when the publisher identifies an actual defect or expressly requests revision.

Required Cover Architecture

- Use one subject-specific image as full-page, full-bleed artwork covering the entire 2:3 cover frame. Do not divide the cover into separate image and text fields.
- Do not place the Zay-Marie Press logo or tagline on the forward cover template.
- Place a concise subject-category label in the upper-right corner. Use the shortest accurate category form, such as “DOCTRINE,” and preserve a generous right-side safe margin after final PDF integration.
- Do not place a study number on the cover template.
- Center the title in the upper visual field. Set it in a crisp, solid, bold sans-serif typeface with immediate readability, strong contrast, and clear dominance.
- Center the subtitle beneath the title in the same bold sans-serif family. Keep it clearly subordinate through size and line arrangement while preserving strong thumbnail readability.

- Do not use a divider, separator rule, frame, footer band, or separate solid-color panel. The approved artwork must remain visibly continuous across the entire cover.
- A restrained transparent gradient, vignette, or text shadow may be used when necessary for legibility, but it must not read as a separate panel or obscure the subject artwork.
- Center the bottom imprint “DIGITAL STUDIES SERIES” near the lower edge directly over the artwork. Do not add side rules, decorative dividers, or a colored footer bar.

Cover Production Method

Generate or select the subject artwork as a clean, text-free portrait image in a 2:3 ratio whenever possible. The image must support clear text placement in the upper visual field and remain meaningful when reduced to website-card size.

Assemble the category label, title, subtitle, and series imprint deterministically in the production layout rather than asking an image generator to render essential typography. The subject artwork may vary by study, but the approved hierarchy and placement system remain consistent unless the publisher approves a substantive redesign.

Cover Art Brief (added v1.19)

Before artwork is generated, prepare a detailed written cover art brief for the study. The brief must describe: the recommended central image concept; composition and framing, including the space reserved for the upper-right category label, the centered title and subtitle, and the bottom imprint; palette, lighting, and mood, consistent with the established series look; specific symbolic details to consider; and elements to avoid (baked-in text, identifiable faces, denominational iconography, anachronisms, AI-generation badges or watermarks).

Deliver the brief to the publisher, who forwards it to the illustrator or uses it directly with an image-generation tool and returns the resulting artwork. The brief is descriptive guidance only — it does not itself constitute the approved cover. The returned artwork remains subject to the full Cover Readability and Approval requirements below, including the publisher's approval at Checkpoint 3 before any integration into the website or final files.

Cover Readability and Approval

- Preserve generous safe margins around the upper-right category, centered title and subtitle, important subject details, and bottom imprint. Recheck these margins after the cover is placed into the final DOCX and PDF; integration must not enlarge, crop, or shift the approved composition.
- Do not use soft, distressed, blurred, thin, decorative, serif, or heavy-outline title and subtitle treatments. Both must remain bold sans-serif and sharply rendered.
- Export the authoritative cover at a 2:3 ratio, using 1600 × 2400 pixels as the standard production size. Inspect it at full size and at 320 × 480 pixels, the catalog-thumbnail QA size.

- Confirm spelling, line breaks, hierarchy, contrast, uncropped artwork, safe margins, and thumbnail legibility before approval.
- After approval, use the same authoritative cover composition in the final DOCX, final PDF, catalog card, and individual preview page. Website optimization and document integration must not crop, soften, distort, enlarge beyond the page frame, or otherwise alter it.

3. Required Final PDF and Interior Sequence

Every final Digital Study must use the following publication architecture in this order:

1. Approved Cover Page — retained as the first physical PDF page; unnumbered and without the interior footer
2. Interior Title Page — retained immediately after the cover and counted as interior page 1; the visible number may be suppressed
3. Table of Contents
4. What You Will Learn in This Study
5. Study Goal — presented as a callout
6. Study Outline
7. Introduction
8. Main Teaching — structured, organized, hierarchical, and numbered
9. Conclusion
10. Study Summary
11. Key Distinctions to Retain
12. Scripture-Tracing Exercise
13. Review and Discussion Questions
14. Teaching Outline
15. Guided Further Study
16. Final Synthesis

FINAL-ASSEMBLY CONTROL: The approved cover must remain in the final DOCX and PDF as the first physical page. Never delete the cover during PDF assembly or substitute the interior title page for it.

PAGINATION CONTROL: The cover is outside the interior numbering system. Interior pagination begins with the title page as page 1, even when its visible page number is suppressed. TOC references must correspond to interior page numbers, not physical PDF page positions.

PAGE-COUNT CONTROL: The 13–17 page content-depth standard applies to the substantive interior. The verified website page-count disclosure must report the complete final PDF total, including the retained cover page.

4. Callout Standard

- Each study must contain 5–7 purposeful callouts.
- The Study Goal is one of the required callouts.
- All callouts must have exactly 10 pt spacing before and 10 pt spacing after.
- The remaining callouts should be distributed naturally throughout the study.
- Callouts should reinforce significant teaching controls, distinctions, interpretive principles, or conclusions; they should not be inserted merely to satisfy the numerical requirement.

CALLOUT CONTROL: Exactly 10 pt before and 10 pt after each callout. Internal padding must use the approved compact publisher-grade treatment established in Study #10: approximately 7 pt top and bottom and 8 pt left and right, with balanced breathing room around the text.

- All callout boxes must provide sufficient but restrained internal padding so that text never appears crowded against the border and the box does not contain excessive empty space.
- Internal padding must be approximately 7 pt on the top and bottom and 8 pt on the left and right, applied consistently throughout the study unless a specific callout requires a minor optical adjustment.
- The 10 pt spacing-before/spacing-after requirement controls the space outside the callout box; internal padding controls the breathing room inside the box. Both requirements must be satisfied independently.
- Text must never visually touch or press against a callout border. Padding must remain compact, balanced, and publisher-grade, matching the approved Study #10 PDF appearance.

5. Table of Contents Standard

- The Table of Contents must be presented as a dedicated, neatly organized interior component.
- The Table of Contents must be numbered.
- Each topic line must show its final page number at the far right.
- Topic lines and page numbers must be aligned consistently and structured for quick visual scanning.
- Production placeholders such as “final page numbers will be inserted later” are not permitted in the finished study.
- The Table of Contents must appear on a dedicated page and use the mature Digital Studies TOC architecture.
- All TOC entry text must begin on a consistent left-aligned axis.
- Page numbers must be right aligned on one common vertical axis at the far right.
- Dot leaders must run cleanly between each entry and its page number.
- Typography, line spacing, and entry spacing must remain uniform and compact throughout the TOC.

- The established hierarchy of numbered teaching sections and closing instructional components must be preserved.
- Long entries may wrap naturally, but wrapped lines must use controlled indentation and must not disturb the common page-number axis.
- Final TOC page numbers must be synchronized against the authoritative rendered PDF after pagination is complete. The PDF—not the editable DOCX view—is the final visual authority for TOC pagination and alignment.
- The approved Study #14 — Why Acts 9 Matters TOC treatment is the forward visual benchmark for this alignment standard.

6. Body-Content Standard

The teaching body must be structured, organized, numbered, hierarchical, and progressive. It must develop the biblical argument in a deliberate sequence rather than present a loose collection of paragraphs.

The number of major teaching sections is subject-dependent. No fixed number of sections is imposed on every study. Each study should contain as many numbered sections and subsections as are necessary to develop its subject clearly and thoroughly.

7. Required Closing and Instructional Components

Conclusion: Brings the study’s main biblical argument to a clear conclusion without introducing an unrelated new argument.

Study Summary: Restates the study’s central argument and major findings in a concise, usable form.

Key Distinctions to Retain: Identifies the principal distinctions the reader must preserve when interpreting or teaching the subject.

Scripture-Tracing Exercise: Requires the reader to trace the argument through the relevant biblical passages rather than merely repeat conclusions.

Review and Discussion Questions: Tests comprehension, interpretation, and the reader’s ability to explain the study.

Teaching Outline: Provides an organized framework the reader can use to explain or teach the study to another person.

Guided Further Study: Explains how the reader should continue the investigation and provides grouped additional passages. Instructions must tell the reader to open and read the cited passages in context, observe the assigned subject or distinction, compare the evidence with the study’s controlling framework, and record a concise conclusion. A bare list of references is not sufficient.

Final Synthesis: Requires the reader to bring the evidence together and articulate the biblical case as a coherent whole.

8. Color Typography Control

Where the Digital Studies design uses blue font, use the established dark blue rather than light blue. Light blue may remain as an approved callout fill/background or other non-text design element, but light-blue font is not to be used.

9. Production Control

These standards are mandatory for the Zay-Marie Press Digital Studies series unless the publisher explicitly reopens and revises a standard. Subject matter may determine titles, imagery, section count, and the precise content of exercises, but it does not alter the required cover architecture, interior sequence, callout controls, TOC requirements, or closing instructional components.

CONTENT-DEPTH AND PAGE-RANGE STANDARD

Every completed Zay-Marie Press Digital Study must contain 13–17 substantive interior pages, inclusive. The retained cover is added as the first physical page and does not satisfy the interior content-depth requirement.

The 13–17 interior-page requirement is a content-depth standard, not permission to pad a study. No study may be lengthened with repetition, redundant summaries, oversized spacing, unnecessary visuals, low-value exercises, artificial page breaks, filler paragraphs, or other material added merely to reach the minimum page count.

When a draft falls below 13 substantive interior pages, it must be developed before publication. Expansion should come only from material that genuinely improves the reader's understanding, such as closer exegesis, additional Scripture tracing, difficult-text analysis, contextual clarification, worked examples, diagnostic distinctions, historical background where relevant, or meaningful teaching/application development.

When the substantive interior exceeds 17 pages, it must be tightened, divided, or restructured without sacrificing necessary biblical argument or instructional clarity.

The governing objective is reader value: every Digital Study must provide sufficient depth for the reader to trace the argument from Scripture, understand the interpretive problem, explain the controlling distinctions, and reproduce the reasoning. No fluff. No bloat.

Visual Enhancement & Image Recommendation Standard

During the development and review of every Digital Study, actively evaluate whether an image, photograph, diagram, chart, timeline, map, or other visual would materially improve the reader's understanding or the overall instructional quality of the study.

A visual should be recommended only when it adds genuine instructional value rather than decoration, corresponds naturally to a specific passage, argument, historical event, doctrinal distinction, or teaching point, and can fit comfortably into the page architecture without crowding text, callouts, tables, headings, or other elements.

When a worthwhile visual opportunity is identified, recommend the specific type of visual and its exact proposed placement in the study. New visuals are substantive design decisions and must be presented for approval before integration. Once a visual has been approved, routine production adjustments required to place it cleanly do not require repeated approval unless the adjustment materially changes the approved visual or its purpose.

Avoid unnecessary visual repetition. If a strong image is already serving as the principal cover artwork, do not automatically repeat the same image in the interior unless the second use provides distinct instructional value.

All approved visuals must preserve the Digital Studies publisher-grade standard: appropriate resolution, legibility at normal PDF viewing and print size, balanced placement, adequate surrounding white space, and no clipping, crowding, distortion, or disruption of page flow.

Visual placement and final appearance must be judged from the rendered PDF, which is the authoritative visual/publisher-grade review copy. The DOCX remains the editable production master.

10. Final-Page Imprint and Vertical-Spacing Control

The Zay-Marie Press Digital Studies publication/imprint block must follow the final body content using a fixed 18 pt separation. It must not be vertically distributed, pushed toward the bottom margin, or positioned with blank paragraphs, floating text boxes, page-filling spacers, or other artificial vertical-positioning devices.

The imprint block consists of “ZAY-MARIE PRESS DIGITAL STUDIES” followed by the standard copyright and personal-use notice. The imprint heading uses 18 pt space before and 5 pt space after; the copyright notice uses 0 pt space before. The imprint heading must remain with the copyright notice, and the copyright notice must remain together as a unit.

If insufficient room remains on the final page for the complete imprint block, the entire imprint block moves to the next page. Do not create abnormal white space between Final Synthesis and the imprint in order to force bottom-page placement.

GLOBAL VERTICAL-SPACING RULE: Blank paragraphs must never be used to control vertical spacing in a Digital Study. Spacing around headings, body paragraphs, callouts, tables, diagrams, visuals, exercises, and the final imprint must be controlled through paragraph/table space-before and space-after settings. The rendered PDF is the authoritative visual check.

11. Interior Footer Standard

- Every interior page of every Digital Study must display the series footer: “ZAY-MARIE PRESS DIGITAL STUDIES SERIES.”
- The approved cover page must not display the interior footer.
- The footer must use compact, professional typography and remain visually subordinate to the study content.

- The footer must be positioned consistently on the same baseline throughout the interior and must not crowd body text, tables, callouts, visuals, or the final imprint.
- Visible interior page numbering must remain present and consistent with the established Digital Studies architecture.
- The rendered PDF is the final authority for footer placement, page-number visibility, and clearance from the bottom margin.

12. Website Page-Count Disclosure Standard

- Every individual Digital Study preview page must display the verified finished-PDF page count in the hero purchase line.
- Use the format “DIGITAL PDF · [NUMBER] PAGES” beside the study price. The main catalog cards remain uncluttered and do not require page counts.
- The page count must be taken from the approved final PDF after production formatting and pagination are complete. Draft counts, estimates, DOCX page counts, and counts inferred from preview images are not permitted.
- If a final PDF is revised and its pagination changes, the individual preview page must be updated in the same publication cycle so the displayed count remains accurate.
- Page-count verification is part of final website QA and must be completed before the study is considered published.

13. Tables Symbols and Contrast Standard

- Table header rows must use the approved dark navy treatment with high-contrast light text.
- Alternating green table rows must use a medium, readable tint. Faint light-green fills that reduce text contrast are not permitted.
- Keep 10 pt of controlled spacing before and after every table. Do not create table spacing with blank paragraphs.
- Use compact but sufficient cell padding. Table text must not touch cell borders, and tables must not crowd adjacent callouts or headings.
- Every table cell, header and body alike, must have a visible single-line border on all four edges in a dark tone (matching or near the navy header treatment). Light-gray, faint, or absent borders are not permitted; gridlines must be clearly legible in the rendered PDF.
- Verify all comparison symbols, especially the not-equal sign ($\neq$), in the rendered PDF. A broken, substituted, or missing glyph must be corrected before approval.

14. Study Development and Approval Workflow

The following workflow governs each new Digital Study. Routine production work may proceed continuously, but substantive doctrinal, editorial, cover, or publication decisions require the publisher’s approval at the appropriate checkpoint.

Stage 1 Subject and Positioning

Define the subject, working title, subtitle, and category. Audit the existing catalog for overlap. When two studies address related material, state their distinct purposes clearly and plan reciprocal distinction language for both preview pages when needed.

Stage 2 Doctrinal and Content Architecture

Develop the study under the controlling doctrinal framework and the Acts Overlap model. Build the required sequence, determine the necessary teaching sections, identify major passages, and confirm that the subject can support 13–17 substantive interior pages without repetition or filler.

Stage 3 Draft and Production Master

Create the DOCX production master and PDF review copy. Apply the approved heading hierarchy, dark-navy interior typography, callout treatment, table treatment, page numbers, interior footer, final imprint, and controlled vertical spacing.

Stage 4 Production Audit

Audit spacing, TOC hierarchy and page numbers, Study Outline placement, callout padding, table contrast, symbol rendering, page breaks, footer clearance, final imprint placement, the 13–17 substantive-interior-page range, and the retained cover page. The rendered PDF is the final visual authority; the DOCX remains the editable production master.

Stage 5 Cover Production

Draft a written cover art brief describing the recommended image concept, composition, palette, lighting, and symbolic content for the study, per the Cover Art Brief standard in Section 2, and provide it to the publisher for the illustrator. Once the publisher returns the finished artwork, prepare the cover with the approved full-bleed forward template. Develop a text-free 2:3 subject image, then assemble the upper-right category, centered bold sans-serif title and subtitle, and bottom-centered “DIGITAL STUDIES SERIES” imprint deterministically. Export at 1600 × 2400 pixels, inspect at full size and 320 × 480 pixels, and obtain approval before integration. Retain the approved cover as the first physical page of both final files, keep the interior title page immediately after it, preserve interior pagination, and recheck every cover safe margin after PDF assembly.

Stage 6 Final Content Approval

Present the corrected final PDF for approval. After approval, do not rebuild or rewrite the study unless verification reveals an actual defect or the publisher expressly reopens the content.

Stage 7 Website Package

Create the catalog card, individual preview page, final web cover, and three interior preview images — the Table of Contents, the What You Will Learn page, and one further page of real substance — from the approved final PDF, selected under the Individual Study Preview Selection Standard (Section 16). The catalog description

must accurately reflect the preview-page narrative, vary its opening language across studies, and avoid repetitive formulas such as beginning every card with “Trace.”

Display the verified final PDF page count on the individual preview page, add the study to the correct subject category and curated collection where applicable, update the sitemap, and add reciprocal distinction links when related studies require them.

Stage 8 Repository Publication

Use the normal repository workflow: inspect the existing local repository; confirm the intended branch and prepared changes; commit or confirm the prepared commit; push main directly to GitHub; allow the Cloudflare deployment to complete; and verify the live catalog, preview page, cover and preview assets, page count, navigation, reciprocal links, and sitemap entry.

Use an alternate shared-browser upload process only when the normal repository workflow genuinely remains unavailable. Upload website pages to the repository root and media to the root assets directory. Never create duplicate page files inside assets or a nested assets/assets directory.

Stage 9 Live Verification and Handoff

Report the commit identifier, deployment result, live-page verification, and any limitation that prevented direct verification. Remove only confirmed misplaced duplicates, preserve correct production files, and never claim a live result that was not actually observed.

15. Approved Asset and File Controls

- The approved final DOCX is the editable production master; the approved final PDF is the authoritative visual and pagination reference.
- Generate website preview images only from the approved final PDF.
- Use clear, predictable filenames for the study page, cover, and preview images; verify every referenced path before publication.
- Preserve earlier approved covers and pages unless an actual defect is documented. Forward standards govern new studies and expressly reopened legacy studies.
- Keep temporary experiments, rejected cover variants, and production intermediates out of the published asset paths.

16. Individual Study Preview Selection Standard

THE PREVIEW RULE: Preview pages must give the reader confidence in the value, structure, and seriousness of the study without giving away any of the study’s doctrinal core. Every requirement in this section exists to serve that one governing principle: show the reader why the study matters, not what the study teaches.

Required Preview Set (amended v1.18)

Every Digital Study’s preview section consists of exactly three pages, each serving a distinct, non-overlapping function:

- **Table of Contents** — shows the study’s full structure and scope at a glance, without disclosing any teaching content.
- **What You Will Learn in This Study** — states the value the reader receives and the outline the study follows.
- **One further page of real substance** — a page drawn from the study’s actual teaching that shows the publisher’s clarity, depth, and teaching style, without giving away the study’s thesis, conclusions, or key proof texts.

What the Third Preview Page May Show

- Value — pages that tell the reader what they will learn.
- Structure — pages that show the outline, architecture, or flow of the study.
- Purpose — pages that frame the doctrinal problem the study solves, without resolving it.
- Tone and Quality — pages that demonstrate the publisher’s clarity, precision, and teaching style without stating the study’s conclusions.

What Preview Pages Must Never Show

- Core doctrinal exposition — any page presenting the study’s central teaching sections, key proof texts, or the resolution of the doctrinal question the study answers.
- Any section that resolves the doctrinal tension the study raises, including a Study Summary, Key Distinctions to Retain, Teaching Outline, or Final Synthesis Exercise, even when framed as an exercise rather than exposition — these sections compress or restate the study’s conclusions.
- Consecutive pages that reveal a large share of the study, with one narrow exception: the Table of Contents and the What You Will Learn page may fall on adjacent physical pages, since neither discloses doctrinal content. No other pair of preview pages may be consecutive.

Page Count

Three pages — the Table of Contents, the What You Will Learn page, and one further compliant page of real substance — is the standard for every study, replacing the prior four-page target. If no third page in a given study satisfies both what this section allows and what it forbids, use only the Table of Contents and the What You Will Learn page rather than filling the slot with a borderline or content-revealing page. Set the preview grid’s column count to match the number of previews actually used for that study.

Production Mechanics

- Generate each preview image from the approved final PDF and resize it to match the pixel dimensions of the study’s existing sibling assets; verify dimensions before upload.
- Each preview card’s heading and one-sentence description must describe the page’s function without stating or hinting at the actual answers, conclusions, or teaching content on that page.
- Use the filename pattern study-XX-page-N.jpg, where N is the interior page number referenced in the corresponding HTML preview-card link; verify the referenced path resolves correctly before publication.

- This standard governs new studies going forward and any legacy study whose preview section is expressly reopened; it does not require retrofitting studies not otherwise being revised.

17. Locked Status

STATUS: APPROVED AND LOCKED — DIGITAL STUDIES MASTER STANDARD v1.19

This document is the controlling written reference for the development, correction, audit, approval, website preparation, repository publication, and final verification of current and future Zay-Marie Press Digital Studies.

18. Version History

- v1.19 — Amended Section 2 (Forward Cover System) to add a Cover Art Brief step, and the matching Stage 5 reference in Section 14. Before the illustrator produces artwork, a detailed written cover art brief — image concept, composition, palette, lighting, and symbolic content — is prepared and given to the publisher to provide to the illustrator; the publisher returns the finished artwork for typography assembly and approval. All other sections carry forward unchanged from v1.18.
- v1.18 — Amended Section 16 (Individual Study Preview Selection Standard) and the matching Stage 7 reference in Section 14. The preview set is now fixed at exactly three pages — the Table of Contents, the What You Will Learn page, and one further page of real substance that does not give away the study's thesis — superseding the prior four-page target and the earlier exclusion of the Table of Contents. All other sections carry forward unchanged from v1.17.
- v1.17 — Prior locked edition. Preview standard targeted four non-consecutive pages (flexible two to four), with the Table of Contents excluded from the eligible set.